

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 3
 ♥ Q 9 2
 ♦ K Q 8 7 5
 ♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J 10 7

♦ —

♣ A 9 8 3



♠ J

♥ A 6 5 4 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ 6 5 4

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			
Lead: ♦K			

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 3 2
 ♥ J 3 2
 ♦ 8 7 6 4 3
 ♣ 8 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K 9 8 4

♦ K 9

♣ K 10 6 5



♠ 9 7 6 5 4

♥ Q 5

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A 7 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A 10 7 6

♦ A Q J

♣ Q J 9

West	North	East	South
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2NT

Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
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Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
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All Pass

5♥ by South

Lead: ♠ 3

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3 2
♥ 4 3
♦ J 9 6 2
♣ A 7 6 4

♠ A K Q J

♥ A J 10 7

♦ A 5

♣ K Q 10



♠ 10 9 8 6 4

♥ 6 2

♦ 10 8 3

♣ J 5 2

♠ 7

♥ K Q 9 8 5

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ 9 8 3

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

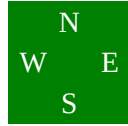
♠ 6 4
 ♥ J 7 2
 ♦ J 10 5 2
 ♣ A 10 9 3

♠ K 10

♥ A K 9 8 4

♦ K Q 8

♣ K Q 6



♠ 9 8 2

♥ Q 10 3

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 7 5 4

♠ A Q J 7 5 3

♥ 6 5

♦ A 4 3

♣ 8 2

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5 ♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6 ♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♠
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ 6
♦ 10 9 6 5
♣ A 9 8 6 3 2

♠ A K Q J
♥ A Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 8
♣ 7



♠ 10 9 8
♥ 7 2
♦ 3 2
♣ K Q J 10 5 4

♠ 7 6 4 2
♥ K J 9 8 5
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ —

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, but you also have a void in ♣s. You therefore answer 6♣. Partner goes all the way to 7♥.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			
7♥ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 8
 ♥ 5 3 2
 ♦ A 9 7
 ♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ K 6 5 2

♥ A Q 7 4

♦ K 8 6

♣ A Q



♠ 4 3

♥ 9 8 6

♦ 5 4 2

♣ 10 9 7 4 3

♠ A 10 9 7

♥ K J 10

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ K J

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♠
All Pass			

5♠ by South

Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 15-17 points and 4 ♠s. You have 18 points and 4 ♠s. You plan to bid the slam, but first you check Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner says 5♣.

You are missing 1 Key-Card. Slam has become less certain. You decide to see if partner has the trump Queen so you bid 5♦. Partner bids 5♠. What do you say next?

Partner denies having the ♠Q. Knowing that the best you could hope for would be a finesse to make the slam you give up your quest and pass.